

1 The directing career of Sidney Lumet span five decades and included classics such as *The Pawn Broker*, *Dog Day Afternoon* and *The Verdict*. In the documentary *By Sidney Lumet*, the prolific filmmaker recalls how his career started in the Depression, when his father cast him in New York's Yiddish theater.

5 Sidney Lumet
"My father taught me about work, new work, and the discipline of work, and the lack of self-indulgence in work."

Lumet was interviewed in 2008 by the filmmaker Daniel Anchor. After both men passed away, director Nancy Burski took over, interweaving the tapes with
10 generous helpings of movie scenes, like this iconic moment from *Network*, of the raving newscaster Howard Beale.

Howard Beale (played by Peter Finch)
"I want all of you to get up out of your chest. I want you to get up right now and go to the window, open it and stick your head out and yell: 'I'm as mad as hell and I'm not going to take this anymore.'"
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Lumet was always attracted to rebels, in *12 Angry Men*, *Serpico* and *Running On Empty*.

Sidney Lumet
"I love characters who are rebels because not accepting the status quo, not accepting the way it's always been done, not accepting that this is the way it has to be is the fundamental area of human progress... And drama, God knows."
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Lumet's films are full of unforgettable characters and now he proves to be one himself. *By Sidney Lumet* is streaming for free this month on pbs.org as part of the American Masters series. For more information, visit wnyc.org/docks

25 Various voices
"I'm as mad as hell and I'm not going to take this anymore."



Sidney Lumet Looks Back

Documentary of the Week | Jan 13, 2017

▶ 2 min



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